

Outlook

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Follow-up: can we distinguish a cyber event from a payments outage?

Hi team,

Timeouts, host-response failures and repeated attempts can resemble malicious activity or ordinary service degradation.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use September 2023 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The timing also overlaps with Prolonged Stage 6 load shedding returns. Treat that as context to test, not an answer.

Can you test these explanations rather than choosing one at the start?

- technical failure explains the cluster
- operational retries are obscuring the original event
- a concentrated account or terminal pattern suggests abuse

The decision is the minimum evidence needed to route an alert to Cyber, Fraud, Payments or Infrastructure. Please give us a Power BI page with drill-through to a reproducible case list.

You should be able to build the evidence from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency. This is triage design from available telemetry, not a substitute for SOC, firewall or application logs.

Thanks